

IEEE Access 33821 - Team Action Brief

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Bottom line: NO-GO as-is, fixable without new data. Controlled results reproduce (join micro-F1 0.890 on 31 images, VLM 0.923, synthetic 0.95 vs 0.36). What blocks resubmission is prose scope, contradictory claims, and package artifacts. The implementation plan is written and the first fix has landed.

Scope: 7 Sept 2026. Covers the resubmission package only: manuscript, response letter, highlighted and clean PDFs, author verification. Full evidence in branch `validation/audit-20260907-astra`.

Latest update

- **Implementation plan written** (`IMPLEMENTATION_PLAN.md` in the audit branch): D1-D4 verdicts, all 12 comments specified, package checklist, 7 OPEN items (all human-side). One planning run, ~20% of quota.
- **First fix applied and pushed** (merge branch, commit `823aef6`): method description now matches the OBB + nearest-pin implementation in both sources. Verified independently, `diff --check` clean.

- **Porting constraint found:** the two revision lines share no git history and patches don't transfer cleanly — T1 is hand porting of `paper-access.tex` plus 4 artifact files, never a merge.

Work on hand (verified, ready to use)

- Controlled results: join 0.890 (418/37/66) on all 31, perfect-wire 0.8898, VLM 0.923 with CIs matching, synthetic L4 0.95 vs 0.36. Reproduced, not just reported.
- Retitle to Structural Circuit Netlists, fully implemented across title, heads, abstract, and conclusion.
- VLM recast as oracle diagnostic with provisional autonomous row (0.247) disclosed without CIs.
- Ablation and per-drafter tables with honest small-cell caveats.
- 12-point response draft with change index and an exact manuscript diff.
- Tau multipliers (0.62/0.30/0.20) and clamps confirmed in code; drafter counts and ablation numbers match committed JSONs.

Decisions for the team (discuss first)

- **D1 — Porting strategy.** Proposal: hand-port the retitle, VLM recast, tables, and response draft onto the revision line, keeping the newer experiments and figures where they supersede.
- **D2 — Retitle lock.** Proposal: accept "Structural Circuit Netlists" (already implemented end-to-end).
- **D3 — Response starting point.** Proposal: use the existing 12-point draft as the base, converted into the IEEE template.
- **D4 — PDF ownership.** Proposal: one owner builds both layouts + highlighted copy and visually checks every page before anyone calls the package done.

Reviewer closeout — status and the one fix per comment

Comment	Status	The fix
R1-1 single corpus / N=31	Partial	Descriptive within-corpus wording; no generalization claims
R1-2 complex-device pins	Gap	Capability table (evaluated vs generic-guess vs export)
R1-3 manual thresholds	Partial	Correct sign; concede extremes untested

Comment	Status	The fix
R1-4 no OCR / not simulatable	Gap	Scope sentence in abstract + intro + conclusion
R1-5 small circuits	Partial	Dense-bus/multilayer limit sentence
R1-6 memristor cites	Gap	Polite decline paragraph in response
R2-1 stats / roadmap	Partial	Roadmap paragraph; fix "same accuracy"
R2-2 VLM oracle / cost	Gap	Conditional wording; drop cost multiples
R2-3 SPICE title	Gap	Retitle + running heads; rebuild PDF
R2-4 crossover merges	Partial	Full tradeoff; GT-box vs detector-miss wording
R2-5 ablation	Partial	Caption sign + scope; unclip Table p.6
R2-6 one scalar limit	Closed	None — keep disclosure as-is

Shared language fixes everywhere: nonsignificance is not equivalence; no global short-free guarantee; GT-box results do not prove end-to-end dominance.

Task list (proposed owners — confirm together)

#	Task	Proposed owner	Blocked by
T1	Hand-port revision content onto the revision line; resolve conflicts keeping newer experiments	Bosco + Pranavesh	D1
T2	Lock retitle across title, heads, abstract, intro, conclusion	Bosco (decision)	D2
T3	Device capability table; fix switch-export wording	Assignee TBD	D1
T4	Response letter in IEEE template from existing draft, incl. R1-6 decline	Assignee TBD	D3

#	Task	Proposed owner	Blocked by
T5	VLM + stats prose pass (conditional wording, roadmap paragraph)	Assignee TBD	D1
T6	Numbers pass (ablation sign, reach label, config ledger, Otsu kept)	Assignee TBD	D1
T7	Rebuild both PDF layouts + highlighted copy; visual page check	Assignee TBD	D4, T1-T6
T8	Author verification: byline, affiliations, ORCIDs, bios, funding, consent	All	—

Numbers to keep straight

- Join 0.890 (418/37/66) reproduced on all 31; perfect-wire 0.8898 — rounds same, not identical.
- 0.9755 = dedup 10°/18px config; mandated 12°/8px gives 0.9726. Label each table.
- Keep Otsu 0.789 (fresh rerun); do not substitute 0.828.
- VLM 0.923, 21/31 exact, 14/15 small — recomputed, CIs match.
- Reach sweep is macro 0.895–0.903 (not 0.898–0.903). Detected-box join 0.247 stays provisional.

Provenance (reference only — not the work plan)

Contributions arrived via PRs #2/#4 (merged harness and experiments), #75/#77 (closed drafts and layout), and the Sept 3 fork branch (retitle, recast, tables, response draft). Verification: audit branch `validation/audit-20260907-astra` (`VALIDATION_NOTES.md` findings F1–F16, `REVIEWER_CLOSEOUT.md`, `PHASE1_ASSESSMENT.md`, `IMPLEMENTATION_PLAN.md`, scratch reruns with pytest 495 passed). Merge branch holds the landed method fix. Decision letter Access-2026-33821 (13 Aug 2026).